

A DAY IN ANGKOR WAT

King Suryavarman II is on his way to visit his temple. He crosses the sacred bridge, carried in a chair on his subjects' shoulders. The king is shaded by parasols but his priests and attendants must endure the full heat of the sun. Ordinary people and animals are not allowed on the bridge at all.



Royal builder

King Suryavarman II built Angkor Wat in the early 12th century. Constructing such a great Hindu temple showed his people and his enemies how powerful he was. His portrait is carved in one of the temple's friezes.

Village life

Large villages sprawled around the temple. Craftsmen and farmers lived here, and traded at markets for food, baskets, pots, and other things they needed.



This carving shows women trading fish at a market stall.



Sickle for cutting rice

Growing rice

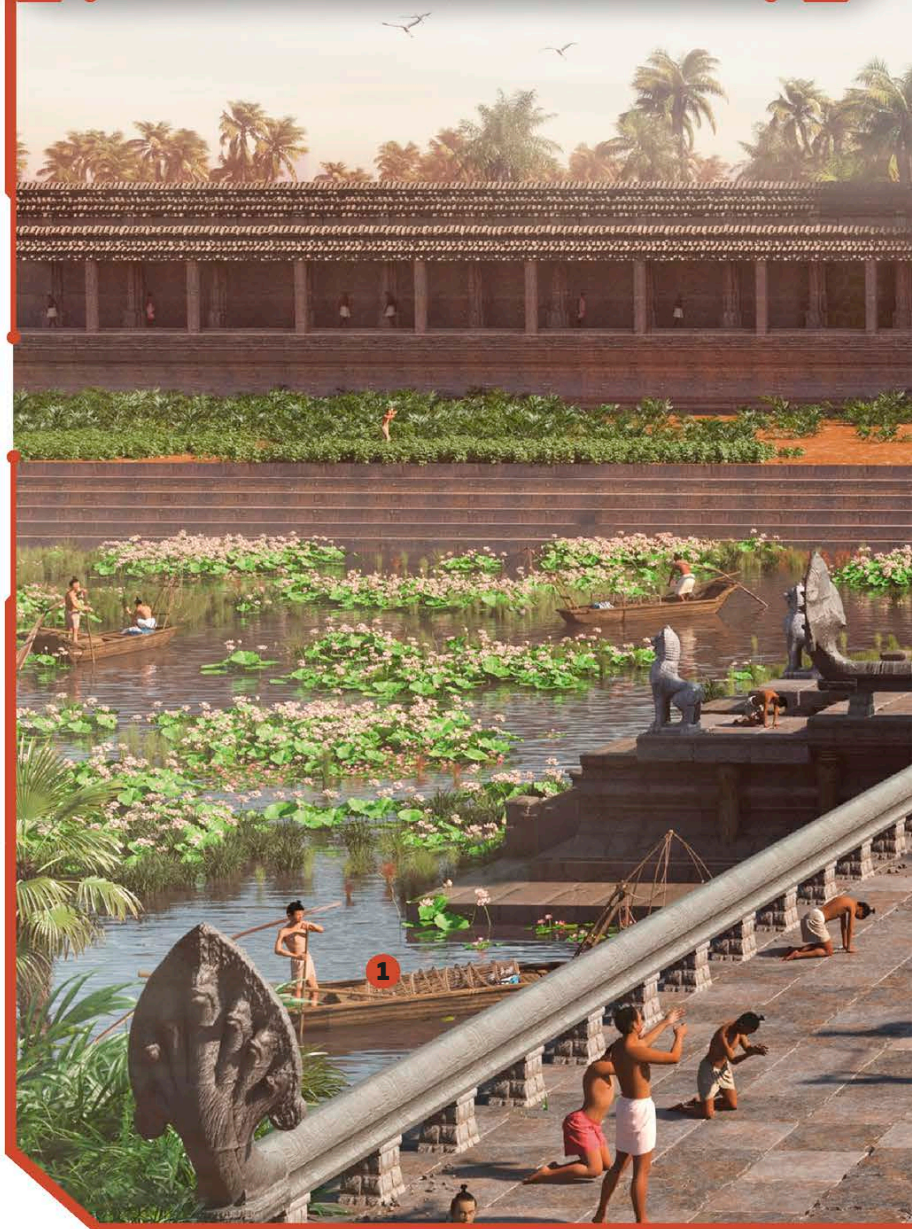
Rice was the main food in the Khmer Empire. People ate it every day, and used it to trade with. They dug complex systems of water channels, which allowed huge quantities of rice to be grown.

Rice grains

Rice plant

Board games

To pass the time, many people played a board game that was similar to chess. Animal fights and sword swallowing were also popular forms of entertainment.



1 Lotus boats

Boats are used to harvest lotus flowers that will be used as offerings in the temple.

2 Procession

Two rows of royal attendants walk toward the temple, carrying offerings.

3 The king

King Suryavarman II is highly revered. He must be shaded by at least nine parasols.